

(d) Measures of dispersion

Students should be taught to:

work out and use the range for data presented in a list or frequency distribution;

work out the quartiles, percentiles and inter-quartile range for discrete and continuous data presented either as a list, frequency table or grouped frequency table;

construct, interpret and use box plots;

understand the advantages and disadvantages of each of the measures of dispersion range, quartiles, inter-quartile range, percentiles;

use an appropriate measure of central tendency together with range, quartiles, inter-quartile range, percentiles to compare distributions of data.

The possible effect of an outlier on range will be expected.

Graphical and other methods will be expected.

The use of box plots could include comparisons.

An awareness that a full comparison needs at least both a measure (or measures) of central tendency and of dispersion.